safe havens across the Indo-Myanmar border. A dialogue process is on with the NSCN and ULFA, and it is hoped that peaceful solutions would emerge out of these deliberations. Many of these groups are bereft of any ideology and have turned into criminal gangs that are resorting to extortion, kidnapping and murders to survive. However, the situation has turned in our favour and the rule of law is being enforced. The elected governments are focusing on development and other people-friendly initiatives. It is my view that the northeast would stabilize and see peace and prosperity in the coming decades.

As far as the Naxal problem is concerned, it has been created partly due to lack of governance and wrong policies adopted over the years vis-a-vis the tribal population in the remote parts of India's heartland. These have now been analysed and are being addressed in a sincere and objective manner. I agree with the present strategy of our government. Having identified sixty worst-affected districts of the country, concentrated efforts for ensuring good governance and re-establishing the rule of law are being put in place, to be followed by integrated programmes for the socioeconomic development of the people. Further, legislation has been enacted to alleviate the problems of the people with regard to forest produce and also to safeguard their other interests. This approach would definitely bear fruit in the coming years and meet the aspirations of the affected tribal population.

Force Restructuring

We have achieved successful force restructuring after the raising and validation of the operational tasks of the South Western Command and 9 Corps. At the same time we have reverted some formations which had been moved to J&K to the eastern theatre, and also inducted units to fill the voids. Besides that, we initiated the process of raising a corps HQ and two infantry divisions and supporting arms and services for the east, in order to enhance our capabilities to meet future challenges. These steps have provided the much desired strategic balance to our posture in both the western and